VOICE BASE CONCEPT ANALYSER(VBCA)

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IN

COMPUTER SCIENCE

ENGINEERING

Submitted by

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DECLARATION

We**, Bhavani Sankar Bhale (192411238),** of the **Computer Science and Engineering,** Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences, Saveetha University, Chennai, hereby declare that the Capstone Project Work entitled **VOICE BASE CONCEPT ANALYSER** Correction is the result of our own Bonafide efforts. To the best of our knowledge, the work presented herein is original, accurate, and has been carried out in accordance with principles of engineering ethics.

Place: Chennai

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the Capstone Project entitled entitled **VOICE BASE CONCEPT ANALYSER** been carried out **Bhavani Sankar Bhale (192411238)** under the supervision **Dr. PONMANIRAJ SAMBASIVAM** is submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the current semester of the Bachelor Of Technology Computer Science Engineering program at Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences, Chennai.

Submitted for the Project work Viva-Voce held on **_---**

INTERNAL EXAMINER EXTERNAL EXAMINER

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ABSTRACT

The **Voice-Based Concept Understanding Analyser (VBCUA)** is an AI-powered assessment system designed to evaluate a student's understanding of technical concepts through spoken explanations. Traditional assessment methods mainly focus on written answers or multiple-choice questions and often require manual evaluation. VBCUA addresses this limitation by automatically analysing the student's voice response and generating an objective evaluation.

The system accepts an audio response from the student and uses **Whisper-based speech-to-text technology** to convert the spoken explanation into text. The extracted transcript is compared with a reference concept using **Sentence-BERT semantic similarity** to determine how closely the student's explanation matches the expected concept. In addition, **Gemini AI** evaluates the correctness of the answer, identifies missing concepts, provides an appropriate reference answer, and generates personalized feedback. Audio characteristics such as speech duration, pauses, energy, and other speech-related features are analysed using **Librosa** to assess fluency.

The results from semantic analysis, AI evaluation, and audio analysis are combined through a scoring mechanism to generate a **final score and understanding level**. The system also provides visual representation through an **audio waveform**, maintains analysis history using **SQLite**, and generates downloadable **PDF evaluation reports** using ReportLab. The application is implemented using **Python, Streamlit, and FastAPI**, providing an interactive interface for students and evaluators.

Overall, VBCUA provides an automated and intelligent approach to spoken conceptual assessment by combining **speech recognition, semantic analysis, large language model evaluation, audio analysis, and automated reporting**. The system helps reduce manual evaluation effort while providing students with immediate and meaningful feedback about their conceptual understanding and speech performance.

TABLE OF CONTENT

CHAPTER 1
INTRODUCTION

1.1 Introduction

In recent years, voice-based technologies and Artificial Intelligence (AI) have become important tools for improving the way people interact with computer systems. Speech recognition, Natural Language Processing (NLP), Machine Learning (ML), and audio signal processing can be combined to develop intelligent systems capable of understanding and evaluating human speech. One important application of these technologies is the automatic evaluation of a person's conceptual understanding based on their spoken explanation.

The Voice-Based Concept Understanding Analyser (VBCUA) is an AI-powered application developed to analyse a user's spoken explanation of a given technical or academic topic. The system allows a user to select or enter a topic, record or upload an audio response, and receive an automated evaluation of the explanation. Instead of evaluating only whether specific keywords are present, the system analyses the meaning of the spoken response and compares it with the expected concept.

The proposed system combines multiple technologies to perform this evaluation. First, the uploaded audio is processed using a speech-to-text model, which converts the user's speech into textual form. The generated transcript is then analysed using semantic similarity techniques to determine how closely the response is related to the expected concept. In addition, audio characteristics are analysed to evaluate aspects of speech delivery such as fluency and pauses. The results from conceptual and audio analysis are combined to produce an overall score.

The system also incorporates an AI-based answer evaluation module to provide more meaningful feedback. The AI evaluator examines whether the student's explanation is conceptually correct, identifies important missing concepts, generates an appropriate reference answer, and provides suggestions for improvement. This makes the application more useful than a conventional keyword-based evaluation system.

The application provides the results through an interactive web interface. Users can view their transcript, semantic similarity score, fluency score, overall score, understanding level, feedback, audio waveform, and generated report. Analysis results can also be stored in a database so that users can review their previous performance through the history section.

1.2 Background of the Project

Traditional methods of evaluating conceptual understanding generally depend on written examinations, multiple-choice questions, assignments, or direct interaction between students and teachers. Although these approaches are useful, they may require significant time and effort when a large number of students need to be evaluated. In addition, written answers do not always represent a student's ability to verbally explain a concept.

Oral explanation is an important part of learning because a student who understands a concept should generally be able to explain its basic principles in their own words. However, manually evaluating spoken explanations for every student can be difficult and time-consuming. Different students may use different words and sentence structures while still expressing the same concept. Therefore, a system that evaluates only exact keywords may incorrectly classify a correct answer as incorrect.

Artificial Intelligence provides an opportunity to automate this process. Speech recognition models can convert spoken responses into text, while NLP and semantic analysis can determine the relationship between the student's response and the expected answer. Semantic similarity is particularly useful because it focuses on the meaning of sentences rather than requiring an exact word-to-word match.

The VBCUA project addresses this requirement by integrating speech processing, semantic analysis, audio analysis, AI-based evaluation, scoring, database management, and report generation into a single application. The system is designed to provide an automated and understandable assessment of a user's conceptual explanation.

1.3 Problem Statement

Evaluating a student's conceptual understanding through spoken answers is traditionally dependent on manual assessment. Teachers or evaluators need to listen to each response, understand the explanation, compare it with the expected concept, and provide feedback. This process becomes challenging when the number of students is large.

Another limitation is that students may express the same concept using different words. For example, a student may explain Machine Learning as a process in which computers learn patterns from data and make predictions, while the reference answer may use completely different wording. A simple keyword-matching system may fail to recognise that both answers convey the same meaning.

Speech-to-text errors also create another challenge. Pronunciation, background noise, pauses, speaking speed, and accents can cause transcription mistakes. Therefore, the evaluation system should be capable of analysing the overall meaning of the response rather than depending entirely on perfect transcription.

Hence, there is a need for an intelligent system that can:

- Convert spoken answers into text.
- Understand the semantic meaning of the response.
- Compare the response with the expected concept.
- Evaluate the correctness of the answer.
- Identify missing concepts.
- Analyse speech fluency.
- Generate a meaningful overall score.
- Provide personalised feedback.
- Store and generate reports of the evaluation.

1.4 Aim of the Project

The main aim of the Voice-Based Concept Understanding Analyser is to develop an intelligent AI-based system that automatically evaluates a user's conceptual understanding from a spoken explanation.

The system aims to combine Speech-to-Text, Natural Language Processing, Semantic Similarity, Large Language Model-based evaluation, Audio Feature Analysis, and automated scoring to provide an efficient and understandable assessment.

1.5 Objectives of the Project

The major objectives of the proposed system are:

1. Speech-to-Text Conversion
   Convert the user's spoken response into readable text using an automatic speech recognition model.
2. Conceptual Understanding Analysis
   Compare the generated transcript with the reference concept using semantic similarity techniques.
3. AI-Based Answer Evaluation
   Evaluate whether the user's explanation is conceptually correct and determine the quality of the answer.
4. Missing Concept Identification
   Identify important concepts that are absent from the user's explanation.
5. Audio Analysis

Analyse speech characteristics such as duration, pauses, and other audio features to estimate fluency.

6. Automated Scoring

   Combine conceptual and speech-related evaluation results to calculate a final score.

7. Understanding-Level Classification

   Categorise the user's performance into levels such as poor, moderate, or strong understanding.

8. Feedback Generation

   Provide clear feedback explaining the strengths and weaknesses of the user's response.

9. Visual Result Presentation

   Display scores, analysis results, and an audio waveform through an interactive user interface.

10. Report Generation

    Generate a structured report containing the user's transcript, scores, evaluation, and feedback.

11. History Management

    Store previous analysis results in a database so users can review their performance later.

1.6 Scope of the Project

The scope of the VBCUA system includes automated evaluation of spoken conceptual explanations. The application can be used in educational environments, internship training, technical interview preparation, self-learning platforms, and skill-assessment systems.

A user can register and log in to the application before accessing the analysis features. After logging in, the user can provide an audio explanation for a selected topic. The system processes the audio, generates a transcript, compares the response with the reference concept, evaluates the answer using AI, analyses speech characteristics, and calculates the final score.

The system also provides a profile and history section where users can view their information and previously completed analyses. Generated reports can be used as records of individual performance.

The current implementation primarily focuses on concept-based spoken answers, particularly technical and academic topics such as Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Cloud Computing, and Data Science. The architecture can be extended in the future to support additional subjects and larger topic databases.

1.7 Significance of the Project

The proposed system can reduce the manual effort required for evaluating spoken conceptual answers. Instead of requiring an evaluator to listen to every response individually, the system can perform an initial automated assessment and provide immediate feedback.

For students, the system provides an opportunity to practise explaining concepts and understand where improvement is required. Immediate feedback can help students improve both conceptual knowledge and communication skills.

For teachers and trainers, the system can reduce repetitive evaluation work and provide a consistent evaluation framework. It can also maintain historical records that help in analysing student progress.

For educational institutions, the system demonstrates how AI can be integrated into learning and assessment processes. The modular architecture also makes it possible to expand the application with additional subjects, evaluation criteria, and AI models.

1.8 Overview of the Proposed System

The overall working process of the VBCUA system can be represented as:

User → Audio Input → Speech-to-Text → Semantic Analysis → AI Evaluation → Audio Analysis → Scoring → Feedback → Report & Database

The user first provides an audio response for a particular topic. The speech recognition module converts the audio into a transcript. The semantic analysis module compares the transcript with the reference concept and calculates a similarity score. The AI evaluation module checks the conceptual correctness of the answer and identifies missing concepts.

At the same time, the audio analysis module extracts speech-related characteristics that can be used to determine fluency. These results are passed to the scoring module, which calculates the final evaluation score. The system then presents the complete result to the user, including the transcript, semantic score, fluency score, final score, understanding level, feedback, and waveform.

Finally, the analysis information can be stored in the database and a report can be generated for future reference.

1.9 Chapter Summary

This chapter introduced the Voice-Based Concept Understanding Analyser, an AI-powered system designed to evaluate spoken conceptual explanations. The chapter discussed the background of the project, the existing problem, project aim, objectives, scope, significance, and overall working concept.

The proposed system combines speech recognition, semantic similarity, AI-based evaluation, audio analysis, automated scoring, database storage, and report generation. By integrating these technologies, VBCUA provides a practical approach for automatically assessing both what the user understands and how effectively the user communicates the concept.

CHAPTER 2

PROBLEM IDENTIFICATION & ANALYSIS

2.1 Description of the Problem

In the current educational environment, students are often required to explain academic and technical concepts verbally during viva examinations, presentations, interviews, and classroom activities. Traditionally, these spoken explanations are evaluated manually by teachers or evaluators. The evaluator has to listen to the student's answer, understand the explanation, compare it with the expected concept, and provide a score and feedback. This process can be time-consuming, especially when a large number of students need to be evaluated. Manual evaluation can also vary depending on the evaluator's judgment and may not always provide detailed information about the student's conceptual understanding and speech performance.

Another important problem is that students may explain the same concept using different words and sentence structures. A simple keyword-based evaluation system may consider an answer incorrect if the exact words from the reference answer are not present, even though the student has correctly understood the concept. For example, a student explaining Machine Learning may use different terms while still correctly describing how computers learn patterns from data and make predictions. Therefore, an effective system should understand the meaning of the student's answer rather than only matching individual words.

Speech recognition also introduces another challenge. When a student speaks, factors such as pronunciation, accent, background noise, speaking speed, and microphone quality can result in incorrect transcription. These transcription errors should not automatically be considered conceptual mistakes. The system therefore needs to analyse the overall meaning of the response and provide a more reliable evaluation. There is also a need to identify missing concepts and provide useful feedback so that students can understand how they can improve their answers.

The Voice-Based Concept Understanding Analyser (VBCUA) is developed to address these limitations by providing an automated platform for analysing spoken conceptual explanations. The system converts the student's speech into text, analyses the conceptual meaning of the response, evaluates the answer using Artificial Intelligence, analyses speech characteristics, and generates an overall performance score. This provides a more comprehensive approach to evaluating spoken answers.

2.2 Evidence of the Problem

The need for such a system can be observed in academic environments where students frequently participate in oral assessments. When many students are required to explain different concepts, manually listening to each response and preparing individual feedback requires considerable time. Students may also receive only a numerical score without knowing which important concepts were missing from their answers or how they can improve their explanations.

The problem becomes more noticeable when speech-to-text technology is used without additional semantic analysis. A student's correct explanation may contain words that are transcribed incorrectly because of pronunciation or audio quality. If the system relies only on exact keyword matching, it may produce an inaccurate evaluation. Similarly, a student may include several correct concepts but fail to explain an important part of the topic. A basic similarity score alone may not clearly explain this limitation.

VBCUA addresses these issues by combining different forms of analysis. The speech recognition component converts the audio into a transcript, while the semantic analysis component measures the similarity between the student's explanation and the expected concept. The AI evaluation component provides a deeper assessment of the answer by checking correctness, generating a suitable reference answer, identifying missing concepts, and providing feedback. Audio analysis is also performed to understand speech-related characteristics and calculate a fluency score. By combining these results, the system provides a more meaningful evaluation than a traditional keyword-based approach.

2.3 Stakeholders

The primary stakeholders of the proposed system are students, faculty members, educational institutions, and trainers. Students can use the system to practise explaining technical concepts and receive immediate feedback about their conceptual understanding and speech performance. Faculty members can use the system as a supporting tool to reduce the amount of manual effort required for repeated spoken assessments. Educational institutions can use the system for viva preparation, technical assessments, presentation practice, and communication-based learning activities. Trainers and mentors can also use the generated reports to identify areas where students need additional guidance.

2.4 Supporting Data and Research

The main input for the system is the student's recorded or uploaded audio response. The audio is processed using a speech-to-text model to generate the corresponding transcript. The transcript is then analysed against a reference concept using Sentence-BERT semantic similarity, which helps determine whether the student's explanation conveys a meaning similar to the expected answer. The system also uses Gemini AI to perform intelligent answer evaluation and generate information such as correctness status, score, explanation, missing concepts, and feedback.

In addition to conceptual analysis, the system performs audio analysis using Librosa and related processing techniques. Speech characteristics such as duration, pauses, energy, and other audio features are considered when evaluating fluency. The results are passed to the scoring component to calculate the final performance score and understanding level. The analysis information is stored using SQLite, allowing users to access their previous results through the history section. The system can also generate a PDF report containing the transcript, scores, evaluation, and feedback.

2.5 Challenges

The development of the proposed system involves several challenges. One of the main challenges is handling speech recognition errors caused by pronunciation, accent, background noise, or unclear audio. Another challenge is accurately understanding answers that use different words but convey the same concept. This requires semantic analysis rather than simple keyword matching. The AI evaluation component may also depend on API availability and usage limits. In addition, audio quality can affect the accuracy of speech and fluency analysis.

Another challenge is combining conceptual understanding and speech performance into a meaningful final score. The system must ensure that a student is not considered incorrect only because of minor transcription errors. Designing a simple and understandable interface for displaying the transcript, semantic score, AI evaluation, fluency score, waveform, final score, and feedback is also important. Despite these challenges, the proposed system provides an effective foundation for automated spoken concept evaluation and can be further improved with additional topics, languages, and speech analysis features.

CHAPTER 3
SOLUTION DESIGN & IMPLEMENTATION

3.1 Development & Design Process

The development of the Voice-Based Concept Understanding Analyser (VBCUA) follows a systematic process to automatically evaluate a user's conceptual understanding through spoken responses. The first stage involves providing an audio input either by recording the user's speech through the microphone or by uploading an existing audio file. The selected topic is also provided to the system so that the response can be evaluated against the expected concept.

The second stage is speech-to-text conversion. The recorded or uploaded audio is processed using the speech recognition module based on Whisper to convert the spoken response into a textual transcript. The generated transcript is then passed to the semantic analysis module. Sentence-BERT (Sentence Transformers) is used to compare the meaning of the student's response with the reference concept and calculate a semantic similarity score.

The third stage involves AI-based answer evaluation. The transcript and topic are evaluated using the Gemini AI model to determine whether the answer is correct, identify important missing concepts, generate a suitable correct answer, and provide meaningful feedback. At the same time, the audio is analysed to extract speech-related features and calculate a fluency score. Finally, the semantic score, AI evaluation, and audio analysis are processed by the scoring module to produce the final result and understanding level.

3.2 Tools & Technologies Used

The project is implemented using a combination of web development, speech processing, artificial intelligence, natural language processing, audio analysis, database, and reporting technologies.

Tool/Technology	Purpose
Python	Main programming language used for developing the application and processing data
Streamlit	Provides the interactive web-based user interface
FastAPI	Provides backend APIs for audio analysis, authentication, and data processing
Whisper	Converts the user's spoken audio into text

Sentence Transformers	Performs semantic similarity analysis between the user's answer and reference concept
Gemini AI	Evaluates answer correctness, missing concepts, explanations, and feedback
Librosa	Performs audio processing and extracts speech-related features
SQLite	Stores user details and previous analysis results
ReportLab	Generates PDF evaluation reports
Matplotlib	Supports graphical representation such as audio waveform visualization
HTML/CSS	Used for designing and improving the application's user interface
Uvicorn	Runs the FastAPI backend server

These technologies work together to create an integrated system capable of converting speech into text, analysing conceptual understanding, evaluating answers using AI, analysing speech performance, and presenting the results through an interactive interface.

3.3 Solution Overview

The proposed solution consists of several interconnected stages. The user first selects a topic and provides an explanation using the microphone or uploads a previously recorded audio file. The audio is sent to the backend for processing. The Whisper speech recognition module converts the audio into text and produces the transcript of the user's response.

The transcript is then analysed using Sentence-BERT semantic similarity to determine how closely the response is related to the reference concept. Gemini AI provides an additional evaluation of the answer by checking its correctness, identifying missing concepts, generating a correct answer, and producing feedback. Audio features are also extracted to calculate the fluency score.

The results from these different modules are passed to the scoring system, which generates the final score and understanding level. The system displays the transcript, semantic similarity, AI evaluation, fluency score, final score, feedback, and waveform to the user. The analysis can also be stored in the database and generated as a PDF report.

Basic solution flow:

Microphone / Audio Upload → Speech-to-Text → Transcript → Semantic Analysis + AI Evaluation → Audio Analysis → Score Calculation → Results & Feedback → Database / PDF Report

3.4 Engineering Standards Applied

Software engineering practices are followed throughout the development of the VBCUA project to maintain reliability, readability, and maintainability. The application is divided into separate modules for speech recognition, semantic analysis, audio analysis, scoring, database operations, waveform generation, and report generation. This modular structure makes the system easier to understand, test, and modify.

The FastAPI backend provides separate API endpoints for user registration, login, audio analysis, history, and report retrieval. Proper database operations are used to store and retrieve analysis information. Error handling is also included so that unexpected problems during audio processing or analysis can be returned without terminating the entire application.

Testing is performed using different spoken responses to check whether the system can correctly generate transcripts, evaluate conceptual understanding, calculate scores, and produce feedback. The project also uses environment variables for sensitive configuration such as the AI API key instead of directly placing the key inside the application source code.

3.5 Ethical Standards Applied

Ethical considerations are important because the system processes users' voice recordings and evaluation results. Audio files and personal information should be handled responsibly and should not be unnecessarily shared with unauthorized users. Sensitive configuration information such as API keys should also be protected and stored using environment variables. The AI-generated evaluation should be considered as an automated assessment and feedback mechanism, rather than an absolute replacement for human judgment. AI and speech recognition models may sometimes produce incorrect results, pronunciation, transcription errors, or limitations of the underlying models.

3.6 Solution Justification

The proposed solution is appropriate because it combines speech recognition, semantic understanding, AI evaluation, and audio analysis into a single application. Instead of manually listening to every response, the system can automatically convert the student's speech into text and evaluate the conceptual content.

The use of Sentence-BERT allows the system to compare the meaning of answers rather than depending only on exact keyword matching. Gemini AI provides deeper evaluation by identifying correctness and missing concepts and generating understandable feedback. Audio analysis provides additional information about speech fluency.

Therefore, combining Speech-to-Text + Semantic Analysis + Gemini AI + Audio Analysis + Automated Scoring provides a practical solution for spoken concept evaluation. The system can help students practise technical explanations, receive immediate feedback, identify missing concepts, and track their previous performance through stored analysis results and generated reports.

CHARTER 4

RESULT & RECOMMENDATIONS

4.1 Evaluation of Results

The proposed Voice-Based Concept Understanding Analyser (VBCUA) successfully provides an automated platform for evaluating a user's conceptual understanding through spoken responses. The system accepts audio through microphone recording or file upload and converts the speech into text using the Whisper speech recognition module. The generated transcript provides the basis for further analysis and allows the user to view what the system has understood from the spoken response.

The semantic analysis component compares the user's transcript with the reference concept using Sentence-BERT and generates a semantic similarity score. In addition, the Gemini AI evaluation component analyses the response and determines whether the answer is correct, identifies missing concepts, generates a suitable correct answer, and provides meaningful feedback. This combination makes the evaluation more effective than simple keyword matching.

The audio analysis component evaluates speech-related characteristics and produces a fluency score. The semantic score, AI evaluation, and fluency analysis are then used to generate the final score and understanding level. The results are presented through the application's results interface along with the transcript, feedback, waveform, and other evaluation details. The system also stores analysis results in the database and supports PDF report generation, allowing users to review their previous performance.

4.2 Challenges Encountered

Several challenges were encountered during the development of the project. One major challenge was achieving accurate speech-to-text conversion. Pronunciation, accent, background noise, speaking speed, and unclear audio can cause transcription errors. In some cases, the transcript may contain incorrect words even when the student has explained the concept correctly.

Another challenge was evaluating answers that use different words but have the same meaning. This required semantic similarity analysis rather than simple keyword matching. Integrating the AI-based evaluation also introduced challenges related to API configuration, authentication, model availability, and API usage limits.

The system also required careful integration of different modules, including speech recognition, semantic analysis, Gemini AI evaluation, audio analysis, scoring, database storage, waveform generation, and PDF report generation. Maintaining communication between these modules while keeping the application simple and user-friendly was another important development challenge.

4.3 Possible Improvements

The proposed system can be improved by supporting a larger number of academic and technical topics. Instead of maintaining only a limited set of reference concepts, the system can be connected to a larger topic database so that users can evaluate explanations across different subjects.

The speech analysis component can also be enhanced by introducing more advanced pronunciation, pitch, speaking-rate, and pause analysis. Support for multiple languages and different accents can further improve the usefulness of the application. The AI evaluation module can also be improved by using more detailed evaluation criteria for different types of questions.

The results interface can be enhanced with additional graphs and visualizations showing semantic score, AI score, fluency score, and final score. Historical performance charts can help students understand their progress over multiple assessments. The system can also be extended with cloud deployment and improved database management for supporting a larger number of users.

4.4 Recommendations

The following recommendations can further improve the effectiveness of the proposed system:

- Use a good-quality microphone and clear audio for better transcription.
- Continue improving speech preprocessing to reduce the effect of background noise.
- Expand the reference concept database with more academic and technical topics.
- Use semantic analysis together with AI evaluation instead of relying only on keyword matching.
- Provide clear feedback and missing concepts so students understand how to improve.
- Store analysis history to help students track their performance over time.
- Add graphs and visual comparisons for better understanding of results.
- Support multiple languages and accents in future versions.
- Regularly evaluate the AI-generated results to maintain reliable assessment.
- Keep API keys and other sensitive configuration details secure using environment variables.

CHAPTER 5
REFLECTION ON LEARNING AND PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT

5.1 Key Learning Outcomes

The development of the Voice-Based Concept Understanding Analyser (VBCUA) provided valuable practical knowledge in Artificial Intelligence, speech processing, Natural Language Processing, and web application development. I learned how spoken audio can be converted into text using speech recognition technology and how the resulting transcript can be analysed to understand the user's response. The project helped me understand the complete process from audio input to automated evaluation and feedback generation.

I gained practical knowledge of Python, FastAPI, Streamlit, Whisper, Sentence Transformers, Gemini AI, Librosa, SQLite, and ReportLab. I learned how semantic similarity can be used to compare a student's explanation with a reference concept based on meaning rather than exact keyword matching. I also learned how an AI model can evaluate an answer, identify missing concepts, generate a correct answer, and provide useful feedback.

Another important learning outcome was understanding how different modules can be integrated into a single application. I learned how audio analysis, semantic analysis, AI evaluation, scoring, database storage, waveform generation, and PDF report generation can work together to produce a complete evaluation system. This project improved my programming, debugging, problem-solving, analytical thinking, and application development skills.

5.2 Challenges Encountered and Overcome

During the development of the project, several challenges were encountered. One of the major challenges was obtaining accurate speech-to-text results because pronunciation, accent, background noise, and speaking speed can affect transcription. This was addressed by using a suitable speech recognition model and combining the transcript analysis with semantic and AI-based evaluation.

Another challenge was replacing the initial hard-coded concept evaluation with an intelligent evaluation approach. Instead of depending only on predefined answers, the project was enhanced using semantic similarity and Gemini AI to evaluate the actual meaning of the student's response. API configuration, model availability, and quota-related issues were also encountered while integrating the AI service and were handled through appropriate configuration and testing.

5.3 Applications of Engineering Standards

Software engineering principles were applied throughout the development of the project to maintain a structured and manageable application. The system was divided into separate modules for speech recognition, semantic analysis, audio analysis, scoring, database operations, waveform generation, and report generation. This modular approach makes the application easier to maintain, test, and improve.

Testing and validation were performed to verify the functionality of audio processing, transcription, semantic analysis, AI evaluation, score calculation, database storage, and report generation. Proper error handling and environment-based configuration were also considered to improve the reliability and security of the application.

5.4 Applications of Ethical Standards

Ethical considerations were taken into account because the system processes users' voice recordings, personal information, and evaluation results. User information and audio data should be handled responsibly and should not be unnecessarily shared with unauthorized persons. Sensitive information such as AI API keys should also be protected and stored securely rather than being directly exposed in the application source code.

The AI-generated evaluation is treated as an automated assessment and feedback mechanism rather than an absolute judgment of a student's ability. Since speech recognition and AI models can sometimes produce incorrect results, the results should be interpreted responsibly. The purpose of the system is to support learning and provide useful feedback rather than unfairly judge a student.

5.5 Insight into the Industry

This project provided valuable insight into the use of Artificial Intelligence, Speech Recognition, NLP, and Generative AI in modern educational and assessment applications. I gained an understanding of how organizations can combine different AI technologies to automate tasks that traditionally require manual effort.

The project also demonstrated the importance of designing systems that are user-friendly, scalable, reliable, and capable of handling real-world input. Working with speech recognition and AI evaluation helped me understand practical challenges such as transcription errors, model limitations, API availability, data management, and result interpretation.

CHAPTER 6
CONCLUSION

6.1 Summary of Key Findings

The Voice-Based Concept Understanding Analyser (VBCUA) demonstrates how Artificial Intelligence, speech recognition, semantic analysis, and audio processing can be combined to automate the evaluation of spoken conceptual answers. The system provides a platform where users can record or upload their voice responses and receive an automated assessment without requiring the complete evaluation process to be performed manually.

The implementation successfully converts spoken responses into text using Whisper, analyses the conceptual similarity using Sentence-BERT, and evaluates the correctness of the response using Gemini AI. The system can identify missing concepts, generate a suitable correct answer, provide an explanation, and produce useful AI-based feedback. Audio analysis is also performed to calculate the fluency score, while the scoring module combines the evaluation results to produce the final score and understanding level.

The system further provides an interactive results interface containing the transcript, semantic similarity score, AI evaluation, fluency score, final score, understanding level, waveform, and feedback. Analysis records can be stored in the database and generated as PDF reports, making the system useful for tracking and reviewing previous performance.

6.2 Impacts and Significance

The proposed system can have a significant impact on student learning and academic assessment. Students can use VBCUA to practise explaining technical concepts verbally and immediately understand whether their answers are conceptually correct. The AI-generated feedback and missing concepts can help students identify weaknesses and improve their explanations.

Faculty members and trainers can use the system as a supporting tool for evaluating spoken responses and reducing repetitive manual assessment work. The availability of transcripts, scores, feedback, and reports makes it easier to review student performance. The system can also be useful for viva preparation, technical interview preparation, presentations, and communication practice.

The combination of semantic analysis and AI evaluation is particularly significant because the system does not depend entirely on exact keyword matching. A student can use different words to explain a concept while still receiving a positive evaluation when the underlying meaning is correct. This provides a more flexible approach to conceptual assessment.

6.3 Future Prospects

The proposed system can be further enhanced by supporting a larger number of academic subjects and technical topics. Future versions can include a larger topic database and automatically generate or retrieve reference concepts for different questions. Multilingual speech recognition can also be introduced to support students who explain concepts in different languages or with different accents.

The speech analysis module can be improved by adding advanced pronunciation, speaking-rate, pitch, pause, and voice-quality analysis. The results dashboard can also include performance graphs and historical progress charts so that students can easily track their improvement over multiple assessments.

Future versions can also integrate additional AI capabilities such as question generation, conversational practice, and an AI chatbot that can interact with students after evaluating their answers. Cloud deployment and scalable database infrastructure can be introduced to support a larger number of users. These enhancements can make VBCUA a more complete AI-based learning and assessment platform.

APPENDICES

APPENDIX A – SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

The Voice-Based Concept Understanding Analyser consists of multiple interconnected components that work together to evaluate a user's spoken explanation. The user can provide an audio response through the microphone or upload an audio file. The audio is processed by the speech-to-text module, followed by semantic analysis, AI-based answer evaluation, audio analysis, scoring, database storage, and report generation.

System Flow:

User → Microphone / Audio Upload → FastAPI Backend → Whisper Speech-to-Text → Sentence-BERT Semantic Analysis + Gemini AI Evaluation → Audio Analysis → Scoring Module → Results Dashboard → Database / PDF Report

APPENDIX B – TECHNOLOGIES USED

Technology	Application in the Project
Python	Main programming language
Streamlit	User interface and web application
FastAPI	Backend API development
Whisper	Speech-to-text conversion
Sentence-BERT	Semantic similarity analysis
Gemini AI	Answer evaluation and feedback generation
Librosa	Audio feature analysis
SQLite	User and analysis data storage
Matplotlib	Waveform/graph visualization
ReportLab	PDF report generation
Uvicorn	FastAPI server execution
HTML/CSS	Interface design and styling

APPENDIX C – MAJOR SYSTEM MODULES

The project is divided into several modules to perform different stages of analysis. The User Authentication Module handles registration and login. The Audio Input Module accepts microphone recordings or uploaded audio files. The Speech Recognition Module converts speech into text using Whisper.

The Semantic Analysis Module compares the generated transcript with the reference concept using Sentence-BERT. The AI Evaluation Module uses Gemini AI to determine answer correctness, generate a correct answer, identify missing concepts, and provide feedback. The Audio Analysis Module evaluates speech characteristics and generates the fluency score.

The Scoring Module combines the analysis results and generates the final score and understanding level. The Waveform Module provides a graphical representation of the audio. The Database Module stores user and analysis information, while the Report Generation Module creates a PDF report containing the evaluation results.

APPENDIX D – SAMPLE INPUT AND OUTPUT

Sample Input

Topic: Machine Learning

Student Speech:

"Machine learning allows computers to learn patterns from data and make predictions without being explicitly programmed."

Sample Output:-

Evaluation Parameter	Result
Topic	Machine Learning
Speech-to-Text	Successfully generated
Semantic Similarity	91.11%
AI Evaluation	Correct
AI Score	95%
Fluency Score	100%
Understanding Level	Strong Understanding
Missing Concepts	None
Final Feedback	Excellent conceptual understanding

The result demonstrates that the system can identify the conceptual meaning of the student's explanation even when the wording differs from the reference answer.

APPENDIX E – SAMPLE AI EVALUATION

The AI evaluation component provides structured information about the student's answer. A typical evaluation contains the answer status, score, correct answer, explanation, missing concepts, and feedback.

Example:

Status: Correct

AI Score: 95%

Correct Answer:

Machine learning is a branch of artificial intelligence where computers learn patterns from data and use those patterns to make predictions or decisions without being explicitly programmed.

Explanation:

The student's response correctly explains the main idea of machine learning by describing how computers learn patterns from data and use those patterns to make predictions.

Missing Concepts:

No major missing concepts identified.

AI Feedback:

Excellent conceptual understanding. The response clearly explains the core concept of machine learning.

APPENDIX F – SAMPLE DATABASE INFORMATION

The system maintains user and analysis information in the database. The stored analysis can include:

- User ID
- Topic
- Transcription
- Semantic Score
- Fluency Score
- Overall Score
- Feedback
- PDF Report Path
- Analysis Date

The stored information allows users to access their previous evaluations through the History section.

APPENDIX G – SAMPLE RESULT SCREEN

The result screen displays the complete evaluation after processing the audio response. It includes the topic, transcript, semantic similarity score, AI evaluation status, AI score, correct answer, explanation, missing concepts, fluency score, final score, understanding level, AI feedback, speech analysis, and waveform.

Screenshots of the actual application can be inserted here.

Figure G.1: Audio Input / Recording Interface

Figure G.2: Speech-to-Text Transcript

APPENDIX I – SAMPLE API ENDPOINTS

Endpoint	Method	Purpose
/	GET	Check API status
/register	POST	Register a user
/login	POST	Authenticate a user
/analyze	POST	Analyse uploaded audio
/save-analysis	POST	Save analysis results
/history/{user_id}	GET	Retrieve user history
/report/{report_id}	GET	Retrieve a particular report

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